

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

The musical score is written for a three-part setting in 3/4 time, featuring treble and bass staves. The key signature has four flats (B-flat, E-flat, A-flat, D-flat). The score is divided into four systems, each with three vocal parts (1, 2, 3) and a common bass line. Chord symbols are placed above the treble staff of each system. The lyrics are written below the staves, with hyphens indicating syllables that span across measures.

System 1: Chords: D $\flat$, E $\flat$ m, A $\flat$, D $\flat$.
1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom

System 2: Chords: D $\flat$, G $\flat$, A $\flat$ sus, A $\flat$, D $\flat$.
hung with bloom a - long the bough,
tween - ty will not come the a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

System 3: Chords: G $\flat$, E $\flat$ m, F.
it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

System 4: Chords: D $\flat$ /F, Fm, E $\flat$ m, A $\flat$, D $\flat$.
wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.